

D022

People and Talent in Educational Leadership

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A principal at a school with a new math wing is hiring an algebra teacher. The last hire, chosen after a friendly, open-ended chat, struggled in the classroom. The district pays for candidates' travel. What process improvement matters most?

- A. Keep the open-ended chat, since it shows personality.
- B. Hire the candidate who seems the best fit with current staff.
- C. Recruit only local candidates to save on travel.
- D. Define the role's key skills, then ask every candidate the same job-related questions and score answers with a shared rubric, including a sample lesson.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A district that just opened a new high school has 14 first-year teachers. The plan is to give each a mentor, and the assistant principal who will formally evaluate them will serve as the mentor for all 14. What is the main problem?

- A. Mentoring is only one part of induction, and the mentor should not be the evaluator, so new teachers can share struggles openly.
- B. The school should wait until year two to support new teachers.
- C. Fourteen is too many; mentoring works only in groups of five or fewer.
- D. The mentor should be chosen from the new school's parent group.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A school already assigns every new teacher a trained mentor who is not an evaluator. What would turn this into a full induction program?

- A. Have the mentor also complete the teacher's evaluation.
- B. Nothing; a mentor is an induction program.
- C. Add orientation, protected collaboration time, targeted professional learning and support over multiple years.
- D. Give new teachers a handbook on the first day.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A sixth-grade team meets weekly in a newly furnished conference room. Most meetings cover field-trip logistics, duty schedules and upcoming assemblies. The team calls itself a PLC. What change would make it function as one?

- A. Focus meetings on common learning goals, shared assessment results, and plans for students who have and have not learned.
- B. Any regular team meeting already counts as a PLC.
- C. Meet twice a week instead of once.
- D. Move meetings to a larger room.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A PLC's common assessment shows 6 of 25 students have already mastered the unit goal. Which PLC question does planning for those 6 students answer?

- A. What do we want students to learn?
- B. How will we extend learning for students who have already mastered it?
- C. How will we respond when students do not learn?
- D. How will we know when they have learned?

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A district with a generous PD budget and a new training center plans to improve science teaching by bringing in a nationally known speaker for one full-day workshop in August. What is the main weakness of the plan?

- A. There is no weakness, since workshops always improve teaching.
- B. One-time training without follow-up coaching, practice and collaboration rarely changes classroom practice.
- C. August is too early; the workshop should be in May.
- D. The speaker is not famous enough.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

In October, a principal who was a math coach for six years visits a teacher's class, notes strengths and one area to work on, and meets to plan next steps. The visit does not count toward the teacher's rating. The school's enrollment grew 8% this year. What type of evaluation is this?

- A. An enrollment review.
- B. Peer review.
- C. Formative evaluation.
- D. Summative evaluation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In May, a principal combines observation evidence and student data to assign a teacher's final rating, which informs a contract renewal decision. What type of evaluation is this?

- A. Formative evaluation.
- B. Self-assessment.
- C. Coaching, since all evaluation is coaching.
- D. Summative evaluation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

After a 30-minute observation in a room with new interactive panels, an assistant principal drafts feedback for a second-year teacher. Which draft is most actionable?

- A. "Great lesson! Keep it up."
- B. A list of 15 things to fix, from transitions to bulletin boards.
- C. "Use the interactive panels more."
- D. "During the 12-minute discussion, you called on 4 of 26 students, all volunteers. Next week, try random calling or turn-and-talk before sharing, and I'll return to look at participation."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher says, “Your feedback said my pacing was off, but I don’t know what you saw.” What was missing from the feedback?

- A.** Praise to balance the criticism.
- B.** Specific evidence of what was observed, such as times and actions.
- C.** Nothing; teachers should accept feedback without explanation.
- D.** A numerical rating.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

Teachers at a school that recently won a district innovation award say they are exhausted: this year they are implementing a new reading program, a behavior system, a technology rollout, a writing initiative and a new grading policy. The award came with a small grant. What should the principal do?

- A.** Keep all five, because every initiative is valuable.
- B.** Add a wellness initiative to address exhaustion.
- C.** Inventory the initiatives with staff, judge each against school goals and evidence, and pause or combine lower-priority ones.
- D.** Use the grant to pay for a sixth initiative.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An assistant principal with a new office and a busy schedule writes a professional growth plan: “Attend three conferences and read two leadership books this year.” Which change would most strengthen it?

- A.** Start from a self-assessment against leadership standards, set one or two specific goals, and name the evidence that will show progress.
- B.** Attend five conferences instead of three.
- C.** Copy a colleague’s plan exactly.
- D.** Drop the plan until the schedule is less busy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A principal ~~at a school with a new math wing~~ is hiring an algebra teacher. The last hire, chosen after a friendly, open-ended chat, struggled in the classroom. ~~The district pays for candidates' travel.~~ What process improvement matters most?

Target word: hiring improvement **Decides:** Use structured, job-related interviews with a common rubric.

A	Inverted operation	Keeps the method that failed.
B	Adjacent category	"Fit" without criteria invites bias.
C	Camouflage	Answers the travel detail, not quality of selection.
D	Correct	Structured, job-based interviews predict performance better.

2. Answer A Concept 2

A district ~~that just opened a new high school~~ has 14 first-year teachers. The plan is to give each a mentor, and the assistant principal who will formally evaluate them will serve as the mentor for all 14. What is the main problem?

Target word: problem with the plan **Decides:** Mentoring alone is not induction, and mixing mentor and evaluator roles undermines trust.

A	Correct	Induction is a full system; support and evaluation roles are kept separate.
B	Inverted operation	Support matters most in year one.
C	Absolute language	Load matters, but no fixed rule; the bigger problem is role conflict.
D	Adjacent category	Mentors should be skilled educators.

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

A school already assigns every new teacher a trained mentor who is not an evaluator. What would turn this into a full induction program?

Target word: what completes induction **Decides:** Induction adds orientation, collaboration time and targeted PD over several years.

A	Inverted operation	Merges the roles that should be separate.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out the other components.
C	Correct	Induction is a multi-part, multi-year system.
D	Adjacent category	Orientation material is one small piece.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A sixth-grade team meets weekly ~~in a newly furnished conference room~~. Most meetings cover field-trip logistics, duty schedules and upcoming assemblies. The team calls itself a PLC. What change would make it function as one?

Target word: what makes it a PLC **Decides:** PLCs focus on evidence of student learning and responses to it.

A	Correct	Those are the core PLC questions.
B	Absolute language	The label requires the learning-focused work.
C	Adjacent category	More time on logistics does not change the focus.
D	Camouflage	The room does not define the work.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A PLC's common assessment shows 6 of 25 students have already mastered the unit goal. Which PLC question does planning for those 6 students answer?

Target word: which PLC question **Decides:** Extending learning for those who already know it.

A	Confusion set	That question sets the goal before instruction.
B	Correct	The fourth PLC question.
C	Inverted operation	That is for students who have not mastered it.
D	Confusion set	That question designs the assessment already given.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A district ~~with a generous PD budget and a new training center~~ plans to improve science teaching by bringing in a ~~nationally known~~ speaker for one full-day workshop in August. What is the main weakness of the plan?

Target word: weakness **Decides:** One-time workshops rarely change practice.

A	Absolute language	Evidence shows one-shot workshops seldom change practice.
B	Correct	Effective PD is sustained and job-embedded.
C	Adjacent category	Timing alone does not fix a one-shot design.
D	Camouflage	Fame does not decide impact.

7. Answer C Concept 5

In October, a principal ~~who was a math coach for six years~~ visits a teacher's class, notes strengths and one area to work on, and meets to plan next steps. The visit does not count toward the teacher's rating. ~~The school's enrollment grew 8% this year.~~ What type of evaluation is this?

Target word: classify the evaluation **Decides:** Its purpose is improvement, not a final judgment.

A	Camouflage	Enrollment growth is unrelated.
B	Confusion set	The principal, not a peer, conducted it.
C	Correct	Ongoing feedback aimed at improving practice.
D	Inverted operation	Summative evaluation makes an end-of-cycle judgment.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

In May, a principal combines observation evidence and student data to assign a teacher's final rating, which informs a contract renewal decision. What type of evaluation is this?

Target word: classify the evaluation **Decides:** An end-of-cycle judgment for a decision.

A	Inverted operation	Formative evaluation is ongoing and improvement-focused.
B	Confusion set	The principal, not the teacher, rates.
C	Absolute language	Coaching and summative judgment serve different purposes.
D	Correct	A final judgment used for decisions.

9. Answer D Concept 6

After a 30-minute observation ~~in a room with new interactive panels~~, an assistant principal drafts feedback for a second-year teacher. Which draft is most actionable?

Target word: most actionable feedback **Decides:** Specific evidence plus one or two clear next steps.

A	Dropped element	No evidence and no next step.
B	Absolute language	Too many items to act on; nothing is prioritized.
C	Camouflage	Answers the equipment detail without evidence of a learning need.
D	Correct	Specific evidence, one high-leverage step, and follow-up.

10. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

A teacher says, “Your feedback said my pacing was off, but I don’t know what you saw.” What was missing from the feedback?

Target word: missing feature **Decides:** Specific observation evidence.

A	Confusion set	Tone does not replace evidence.
B	Correct	Evidence makes feedback understandable and actionable.
C	Inverted operation	Unsupported feedback undermines trust and use.
D	Adjacent category	A score adds judgment, not evidence.

11. Answer C Concept 7

Teachers at a school ~~that recently won a district innovation award~~ say they are exhausted: this year they are implementing a new reading program, a behavior system, a technology rollout, a writing initiative and a new grading policy. ~~The award came with a small grant.~~ What should the principal do?

Target word: response to overload **Decides:** Evaluate initiatives against goals and capacity; pause or combine some.

A	Absolute language	Value alone does not make them all feasible at once.
B	Inverted operation	Adds to the overload.
C	Correct	Fewer, aligned initiatives get implemented well.
D	Camouflage	Answers the grant detail and worsens overload.

12. Answer A Concept 8

An assistant principal ~~with a new office and a busy schedule~~ writes a professional growth plan: “Attend three conferences and read two leadership books this year.” Which change would most strengthen it?

Target word: strengthening the plan **Decides:** Anchor goals in a self-assessment against standards, with evidence of progress.

A	Correct	Growth plans need a baseline, goals and measures.
B	Adjacent category	More activities without goals or evidence.
C	Dropped element	Leaves out the leader’s own self-assessment.
D	Camouflage	Answers the schedule detail, not the plan’s quality.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Structured, job-based hiring	Hiring starts with an analysis of what the position requires; every candidate then gets the same job-related questions scored with the same rubric.	Relying on unstructured conversation, “fit,” or a strong first impression.	An interview process that varies by candidate or by gut feeling.
2	Induction vs. mentoring	Induction is a comprehensive, multi-year system (orientation, mentoring, collaboration time, targeted PD); mentoring is one part, and the mentor’s supportive role is kept separate from formal evaluation.	Assigning a mentor and calling it an induction program, or making the mentor the evaluator.	Supports for new teachers and who does what.
3	Professional learning communities	A PLC is a team that works interdependently on four questions: what students should learn, how we will know, what we do when they don’t learn, and what we do when they already have; the focus is on results.	Calling any staff meeting or book club a PLC.	A team meeting agenda and whether it centers on student learning evidence.
4	Features of effective professional development	Professional learning that changes practice is sustained, job-embedded, content-focused and collaborative, with modeling, practice and follow-up coaching.	Expecting a one-day workshop to change classroom practice.	A PD plan’s length, format and follow-up.
5	Formative vs. summative evaluation of staff	Formative evaluation gives ongoing feedback to improve practice; summative evaluation makes an end-of-cycle judgment for decisions such as rating or renewal.	Treating every observation as a final judgment, or using coaching notes as the final rating.	The purpose of an observation or conference.
6	Actionable feedback	Useful feedback is timely, grounded in specific evidence from the observation, and focused on one or two high-leverage next steps the teacher can act on.	Vague praise, a long list of every flaw, or opinion without evidence.	A draft of post-observation feedback.
7	Managing competing initiatives	Leaders inventory initiatives, judge each against the school’s goals, evidence and staff capacity, and stop or combine some so the most important ones can be done well.	Adding every promising initiative, leading to overload and shallow implementation.	Staff report too many programs at once.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	A personal professional growth plan	A leader's growth plan starts with self-assessment against leadership standards and evidence, sets a few specific goals, and names actions, supports and evidence of progress.	Listing activities or conferences without tying them to a standard or evidence.	A plan that lacks a starting point or a measure.

Course scope (public description): People and Talent in Educational Leadership prepares candidates to understand and implement practices used to recruit, hire, and prepare school personnel to provide students with an optimal learning environment. Various school professional development practices, such as professional learning communities, collaborative learning communities, beginning teacher induction, and mentor programs, will be covered. Additionally the course covers methods to evaluate school personnel appropriately based on data-driven decisions; providing realistic and actionable feedback to school personnel to continuously drive improvement; engaging all school personnel in the use and evaluation of competing school-wide initiatives; creating and sustaining a professional culture of engagement and commitment by developing workplace conditions that promote employee development, well-being, and professional growth; and continuously supporting school personnel to improve their instructional practices through ongoing professional development. The candidate will also reflect on leadership standards in order to develop a personal professional growth plan. A prerequisite for this course is D017: School Law.